



DAK GURU

STUDY BOOKLET • DEPARTMENTAL EXAMINATIONS

Central Civil Services (Recognition of Service Associations) Rules, 1993

Comprehensive, Verified & Exam-Oriented Notes

For the Limited Departmental Competitive Examination

Inspector Posts (IP) & PS Group 'B'

Paper II / III — Establishment, Rules & Procedure

DISCLAIMER

This booklet is prepared by **Dak Guru** purely as a study aid for departmental-examination candidates. It is **not** a substitute for the official Gazette notification, statutory rules, or Government orders. Every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and currency as on the date of preparation; however, rules, orders and instructions are subject to amendment by the competent authority. In case of any conflict, the **original Gazette notification / Government order shall prevail**. Candidates must cross-verify with the latest primary sources before relying on any provision. No liability is accepted for any error, omission, or consequence arising from use of this material.



About This Booklet

These notes give you a **complete, self-contained and exam-ready treatment** of the **Central Civil Services (Recognition of Service Associations) Rules, 1993** — commonly cited as the **CCS (RSA) Rules, 1993**. Every rule is reproduced in substance, explained in plain language, and supported with tables, worked examples, memory aids and likely examination angles.

The subject is small but **high-yield**: it recurs in the establishment/rules paper of the LDCE for Inspector Posts and the PS Group 'B' examination, and the questions are usually direct and fact-based (percentages, dates, 'which authority', 'what is prohibited'). Master the figures and the do's-and-don'ts and these marks are yours.

HOW TO USE THESE NOTES

Read each chapter once for understanding, then revise only the **blue "Key Fact" boxes** and the **At-a-Glance tables** near the end.

Wherever a **number, date or authority** is in bold, treat it as directly examinable.

The **"Exam Trap"** boxes flag the exact points where candidates lose marks.

Verification & Currency Statement

In keeping with Dak Guru's standing policy of **primary-source verification**, the contents of this booklet were checked against official sources on **June 2026**. The position stated is the **latest in force** as on that date.

What was verified	Source relied upon	Status / Date
Full text of the Rules (Rules 1–10)	DoPT, official text of the CCS (RSA) Rules, 1993 (Annexure-I), portal dopt.gov.in	Confirmed
Date of notification & gazette number	DoPT O.M. No. 2/10/80-JCA dated 9 Nov 1993; Notification dated 5 Nov 1993	GSR 689(E), w.e.f. 5 Nov 1993
Constitutional authority	Notification preamble (proviso to Art. 309 + Art. 148(5))	Confirmed
Check-off / verification procedure	DoPT O.M. No. 2/10/80-JCA dated 31 Jan 1994; CGA O.M. dated 9 Jan 2001	Confirmed



What was verified	Source relied upon	Status / Date
Whether the Rule text has been amended	Search of DoPT 'Acts/Rules' and gazette references	No amending GSR traced to the substantive text
Recent operational orders	DoPT O.M.s dated 27 Sep 2023, 16 Aug 2024 & 2025 series (F.No. 17/01/2025-R&R and DC)	Recognition/verification drives — not rule amendments

Note: The DoPT-published text contains a few original typographical quirks (e.g., the sub-clause numbering in Rule 1). These notes preserve the legal substance and silently correct only obvious typographical slips. Where the latest position could not be independently confirmed, it is flagged in the text.





1. Introduction — What These Rules Are About

A **Service Association** is an organised body of Government servants (a union or association) formed to look after the **common service interests** of a particular category of employees — pay, allowances, promotions, working conditions and the like. The Government cannot deal officially with every such body; it deals only with those it formally **recognises**.

The **CCS (RSA) Rules, 1993** lay down **who can be recognised, on what conditions, how membership is counted, and when recognition can be withdrawn**. Recognition is important because it is the **gateway** to almost everything a staff body wants to do officially — send representations, sit in the Joint Consultative Machinery (JCM), and have its subscriptions deducted through the pay-roll.

WHY AN IP / PS GR. B CANDIDATE MUST KNOW THIS

Recognition is a recurring topic in the establishment paper; the figures (35%, 15%), the 'before 1st July' deadline, and the list of prohibitions are favourite one-mark questions.

As a future Inspector / Group 'B' officer you will deal with recognised associations and the JCM at the divisional and circle level, so the working knowledge is practical, not just theoretical.

These Rules sit alongside the **CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964** (which govern an individual servant's conduct, including taking part in association activity) and the **JCM Scheme** (the formal negotiating forum). Keep the three mentally linked.



2. Legislative Foundation & Background

2.1 The earlier 1959 Rules and why fresh rules were needed

Recognition was earlier governed by the **CCS (Recognition of Service Associations) Rules, 1959**. Departmental records note that, following developments in the courts in the mid-1960s, the 1959 Rules became difficult to operate, and for a long period Departments dealt with associations informally, without insisting on formal recognition, provided the associations broadly satisfied the main features of the old rules.

To put recognition back on a clear statutory footing, the Government framed the **CCS (RSA) Rules, 1993**.

CAUTION – DO NOT OVER-STATE THE CASE-LAW

Some study material attributes the eclipse of the 1959 Rules to a specific Supreme Court judgment. As that case citation could not be independently verified from a primary source, this booklet describes the background only in general terms. Do not quote a case name in the examination unless your official source gives one.

2.2 Notification – the essential facts

Particular	Detail
Short title	Central Civil Services (Recognition of Service Associations) Rules, 1993
Notified on	5 November 1993
Gazette reference	G.S.R. 689(E)
Published in	Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part II, Section 3, Sub-section (i)
Takes effect from	5 November 1993
Made by	The President of India
Power exercised under	Proviso to Article 309 and clause (5) of Article 148 of the Constitution
Special consultation	Comptroller & Auditor General (for persons in the Indian Audit & Accounts Department)
Supersedes	CCS (Recognition of Service Associations) Rules, 1959
Circulated vide	DoPT O.M. No. 2/10/80-JCA dated 9 November 1993
Signed by	Shri J. S. Mathur, Joint Secretary to the Government of India



Particular	Detail
KEY FACT	
Made under the proviso to Article 309 + Article 148(5) ; notified 5 Nov 1993 as GSR 689(E) ; supersedes the 1959 Rules . These four facts are the most commonly asked.	





3. Key Definitions (Rule 2)

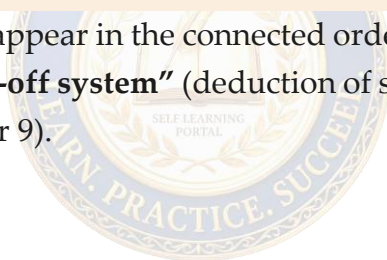
Only two terms are formally defined, but they carry a lot of weight:

Term	Meaning under the Rules	Why it matters
"Government"	The Central Government.	Recognition is granted by the Central Government / the concerned Ministry or Department.
"Government servant"	Any person to whom the CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964 apply.	Eligibility to be a member flows from the Conduct Rules — if those rules apply to you, you are a 'Government servant' for this purpose.

EXAM TRAP

"Government servant" is **not** defined by post or pay; it is defined by **reference to the CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964**. Watch for options that define it as 'any Central Government employee' — the precise answer ties it to the Conduct Rules.

Two further working terms appear in the connected orders: a **"Federation"** (a body of associations) and the **"check-off system"** (deduction of subscription from the pay-roll — explained fully in Chapter 9).





4. Application & Scope (Rule 3)

The Rules apply to service associations of **all Government servants, including civilian Government servants in the Defence Services**. They do **not** apply to two groups, who have their own separate recognition rules:

Covered by the 1993 Rules	NOT covered (separate rules apply)
Associations of all Central Government servants	Industrial employees of the Ministry of Railways
Civilian Government servants in the Defence Services	Workers employed in Defence Installations of the Ministry of Defence

KEY FACT

Excluded: **(1)** industrial employees of **Railways** and **(2)** workers in **Defence Installations of MoD**. **Civilian** defence employees, by contrast, **are covered**.



5. Associations Already Recognised (Rule 4)

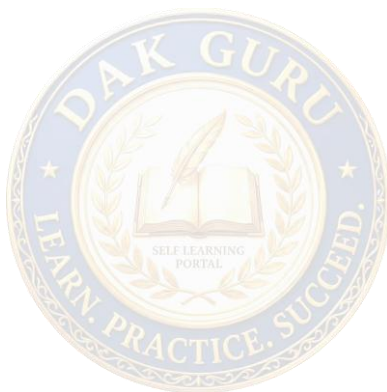
When the new Rules came in, existing associations were not thrown out overnight. An association or federation that was already recognised — and whose recognition was subsisting when these Rules commenced — **continued to be recognised** for:

- **one year** from the commencement of these Rules, **OR**
- until its recognition was withdrawn,

whichever is earlier. This was a transitional bridge: it gave existing bodies time to apply afresh and meet the new conditions.

KEY FACT

Transition window for pre-existing associations = **1 year** from commencement **or** till recognition withdrawn, **whichever earlier.**





6. Conditions for Recognition (Rule 5)

This is the heart of the Rules. An association may be recognised only if it satisfies **all** of the following conditions, (a) to (h):

Clause	Condition for recognition
5(a)	An application has been made to the Government with the Memorandum of Association, Constitution, Bye-laws, names of office-bearers, total membership , and any other information required.
5(b)	The association is formed primarily to promote the common service interest of its members.
5(c)	Membership is restricted to a distinct category of Government servants having a common interest — and all such servants are eligible to join.
5(d)(i)	The association represents a minimum of 35% of the total number of a category of employees. Proviso: where only one association commands more than 35%, a second association with the next-highest membership may also be recognised even if below 35%, provided it commands at least 15% .
5(d)(ii)	A member's membership is automatically discontinued once he ceases to belong to that category.
5(e)	Only Government employees who are in service may be members or office-bearers.
5(f)	The association is not formed to represent interests on the basis of caste, tribe or religious denomination (or any group/section within them).
5(g)	The Executive has been appointed from amongst the members only.
5(h)	Funds consist exclusively of members' subscriptions and any Government grants, and are applied only for the association's objects.

6.1 The 35% / 15% membership rule — worked examples

This is the single most-tested point. Read the proviso carefully: the **15% relaxation** is available **only when there is exactly one association above 35%**, and it benefits **only the association with the second-highest membership**.

Situation	Who gets recognition?
Association A has 40%; Association B has 30%; C has 20%	A is recognised (>35%). As only one association is above 35%, B — the second-highest — is also recognised because it has ≥15% . C is not.
A has 38%; B has 12%	A is recognised. B is not — it is below the 15% floor.



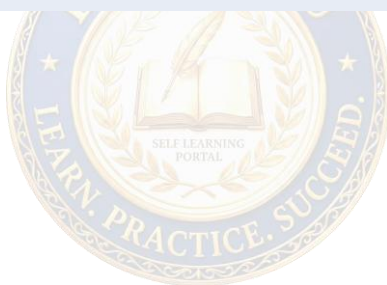
Situation	Who gets recognition?
A has 45%; B has 40%	Both are above 35%, so the proviso is not triggered; each qualifies on its own 35% strength. (The proviso only helps a sub-35% runner-up.)
A has 30%; B has 28%	Neither reaches 35% and no association is above 35%, so the proviso cannot apply — none qualifies on these figures.

EXAM TRAP

The 15% second-association concession applies **only if exactly one association is above 35%**. If **no** association crosses 35%, even a body with, say, 20% gets **nothing** — there is no 'highest-among-low' recognition.

KEY FACT

Recognition threshold = **35%** of the category. Second association = **15%** (only when one body already exceeds 35%). Only **serving** employees as members/office-bearers; **no** caste/tribe/religion basis; funds only from **subscriptions + Government grants**.



7. Conditions for Continued Recognition (Rule 6)

Recognition is not permanent; it must be **earned every year by good conduct**. Every recognised association must comply with conditions (a) to (l). The easiest way to remember them is to split them into “**must-do**” and “**must-not-do**”.

7.1 The association **MUST** —

- [6(d)] submit all representations **through proper channel**, addressed to the Secretary to the Government / Head of the Organisation, Department or office;
- [6(e)] furnish, **annually and through proper channel after its general annual meeting, a list of members and office-bearers, an up-to-date copy of its rules, and an audited statement of accounts** — so as to reach the Government **before the 1st day of July each year**;
- [6(f)] abide by and comply with all provisions of its own constitution / bye-laws;
- [6(g)] obtain **prior approval** of the Government before amending its constitution / bye-laws.

7.2 The association **MUST NOT** —

- [6(a)] send any representation or deputation except on a matter of **common interest** to members;
- [6(b)] espouse or support the cause of **individual** Government servants in service matters;
- [6(c)] maintain any **political fund**, or lend itself to propagating the views of any political party or its members;
- [6(h)] start or publish any periodical, magazine or bulletin **without previous approval** of the Government;
- [6(i)] continue such publication if directed by the Government to stop (on grounds that it is prejudicial to the interests of the Central / State Government or any Government authority, to good relations between Government servants and Government, or to relations with a foreign State);
- [6(j)] correspond with a **foreign authority** except through the Government (which may withhold the communication);
- [6(k)] do, or assist in doing, any act which would contravene the **CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964** if done by a Government servant;
- [6(l)] use any **disrespectful or improper language** in communications to the Government or a Government authority.



KEY FACT – THE '1ST JULY' RETURN

The annual return (members + office-bearers list, up-to-date rules, audited accounts) must reach the Government **before 1 July every year**, routed **through proper channel after the AGM**. A very common date-based question.

EXAM TRAP

Note the contrast: an association exists for **common** interests (Rule 6(a)) and is expressly barred from taking up **individual** service matters (Rule 6(b)). 'Common vs individual' is a classic distractor. Also remember: **no political fund** and **no publication without prior approval**.





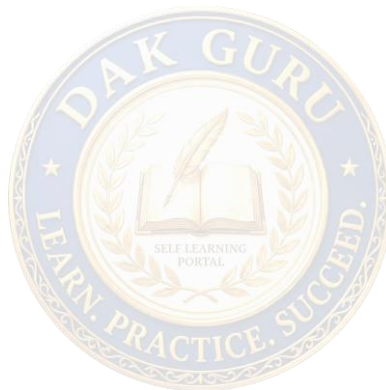
8. Verification of Membership (Rule 7)

How does the Government know an association really has 35%? By **verifying membership**, and the prescribed method is the **check-off system**.

- **Rule 7(1)** — Verification is done by the **check-off system in pay-rolls**, at such intervals and in such manner as the Government may by order prescribe.
- **Rule 7(2)** — The Government may, **at any time**, order a **special verification** if it is of the opinion, **after an enquiry**, that the association does not have the membership required under Rule 5(d)(i).

KEY FACT

Membership is verified through the **check-off (pay-roll deduction) system**. A **special verification** can be ordered **at any time, after an enquiry**, if the 35% requirement seems unmet.





9. The Check-Off System in Detail

The mechanics of the check-off system come from the connected DoPT order, **O.M. No. 2/10/80-JCA dated 31 January 1994**, read with the accounting procedure laid down by the **Controller General of Accounts (O.M. dated 9 January 2001)**.

9.1 What it is and how it works

The **check-off system** verifies membership on the basis of **deduction of subscription from the pay-roll**. Each member gives **written consent** to the Drawing & Disbursing Officer (DDO), or other designated authority, authorising deduction of the annual subscription in favour of a particular association. The association confirms membership and the DDO effects the recovery.

9.2 The rules you must remember

Point	Rule
One association only	Under the check-off system a Government servant may subscribe to only ONE association.
Only paid members count	For the 35% requirement of Rule 5(d)(i), only members who have paid subscription through the check-off system are counted.
When option is exercised	Consent remains valid till altered or withdrawn . A revised option may be exercised only in April each year, to take effect from July of that year.
When recovery is made	Recovery of the annual subscription is made by the DDO once a year, in the month of July .
Accounting procedure	Recovery, accounting and consolidation are governed by the CGA's O.M. dated 9 January 2001 .

EXAM TRAP – DON'T CONFUSE THE MONTHS

Option to change association = **April** (effective July). Recovery of subscription = **July**. A 'crucial month' for a particular verification cycle is fixed separately by order (for example, June was fixed as the crucial month in the 2007 Secretariat verification). Keep **April (option)**, **July (recovery)** and the cycle-specific 'crucial month' distinct.

KEY FACT

Check-off essentials: **one association per employee**; only **check-off-paid** members count for 35%; option only in **April** (effect July); recovery **once a year in July**.



10. Withdrawal of Recognition (Rule 8)

If, in the opinion of the Government, a recognised association has **failed to comply with any condition under Rule 5, Rule 6 or Rule 7**, the Government may withdraw its recognition. Crucially, this can be done **only after giving the association an opportunity to present its case** — a built-in safeguard of **natural justice**.

KEY FACT

Recognition may be withdrawn for breach of **Rule 5, 6 or 7**, but **only after an opportunity to be heard** is given to the association.





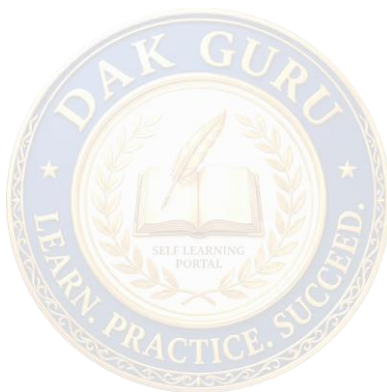
11. Relaxation (Rule 9)

The Government may **dispense with or relax** the requirements of any of these Rules, to such extent and subject to such conditions as it may deem fit, in regard to any service association.

By the forwarding O.M. dated 9 November 1993, the Government directed that any relaxation under Rule 9 must be done **only with the prior approval of the Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT)**.

KEY FACT

Power to relax lies with the Government under **Rule 9**, but **prior DoPT approval** is required before any relaxation is granted.





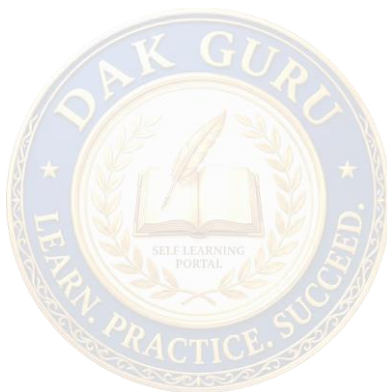
12. Interpretation (Rule 10)

If any question arises about the interpretation of these Rules, or any dispute about whether the conditions for recognition are fulfilled, it must be **referred to the Government, whose decision is final.**

Operationally, the forwarding O.M. of 9 November 1993 directs that **doubts on interpretation be referred to the JCA Division of the DoPT** for clarification.

KEY FACT

Disputes/interpretation → **decided by the Government, decision final**; doubts in practice are referred to the **JCA Division, DoPT.**





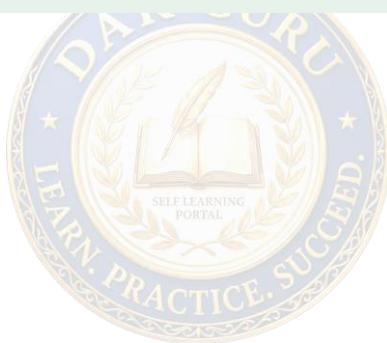
13. Link with the JCM Scheme

Recognition under these Rules is not an end in itself — it is the **entry ticket to the Joint Consultative Machinery (JCM)**, the formal forum through which the official side and the staff side negotiate service matters. Only **recognised** associations are taken on the staff side of the JCM councils (the National Council, Departmental Councils and Office/Regional Councils).

This linkage is visible in current practice. In its **2025** orders the DoPT clarified that, for constituting the **Departmental Council under the JCM Scheme**, it grants recognition to associations belonging to the **Central Secretariat** (Ministries/Departments, excluding Railways) rather than to the entire Central Government.

GOOD TO KNOW

Think of the chain: **form an association → satisfy Rule 5 → get recognised → verified via check-off → take a seat on the JCM**. Recognition is the hinge in the middle.





14. Current Position & Recent Developments

As verified on **29 June 2026**, the **substantive text of the Rules (Rules 1–10) remains as notified in 1993**; no amending notification to the rule text was traced. What has been active in recent years is a series of **operational orders** — recognition and re-verification drives — issued by the DoPT's R&R and DC Division. Notable ones include:

- O.M. dated **27 September 2023** — extension of validity of recognition of certain Central Secretariat associations for one year;
- O.M. dated **16 August 2024** — extension of the deadline for granting recognition under the Rules;
- The **F.No. 17/01/2025-R&R and DC** series (O.M.s dated 2 July, 13 August and 12 September 2025) and a further order in November 2025 — dealing with applications and membership verification of CSS / CSCS / CSSS associations, including a clarification that for the Departmental Council the name and membership must be confined to the Central Secretariat (excluding Railways).

HOW TO TREAT THIS IN THE EXAM

For rule-based questions, rely on the **1993 text** — it is unchanged. Treat the 2023–2025 items as **administrative/verification orders**, useful for current-affairs-style questions but **not** amendments to the Rules themselves. If a question hinges on a very recent order, verify against the latest DoPT circular before answering.



15. Key Facts & Figures — At a Glance

Revise only this page on the last day before the examination.

Item	Value to remember
Name & year	CCS (Recognition of Service Associations) Rules, 1993
Date of notification	5 November 1993
Gazette number	GSR 689(E)
Constitutional source	Proviso to Art. 309 + Art. 148(5)
Supersedes	CCS (RSA) Rules, 1959
Total number of rules	10
Minimum membership for recognition	35%
Second association threshold	15%
Transition for old associations	1 year or till withdrawal, whichever earlier
Annual return due	Before 1 July each year
Option to change association	April (effective July)
Subscription recovery	Once a year, in July
Associations per employee (check-off)	One
Excluded employees	Railway industrial employees; workers in Defence Installations of MoD
Verification method	Check-off system in pay-rolls
Relaxation needs	Prior approval of DoPT (Rule 9)
Interpretation / disputes	Government's decision is final (Rule 10); doubts → JCA Division, DoPT



16. Rule-wise Quick Summary

Rule	Heading	Crux
1	Short title & commencement	Called CCS (RSA) Rules, 1993; in force from date of Gazette publication.
2	Definition	"Government" = Central Govt; "Government servant" = one to whom CCS (Conduct) Rules, 1964 apply.
3	Application	All Central Govt servants incl. civilian defence; excludes Railway industrial staff & MoD installation workers.
4	Associations already recognised	Continue 1 year or till withdrawal, whichever earlier.
5	Conditions for recognition	Application + documents; common service interest; distinct category; 35% (second 15%); serving members only; no caste/tribe/religion; executive from members; clean funds.
6	Conditions for continued recognition	Proper channel; annual return before 1 July; no political fund; no individual cases; no unapproved publication; no improper language; etc.
7	Verification of membership	Check-off system; special verification possible after enquiry.
8	Withdrawal of recognition	For breach of Rule 5/6/7, after opportunity to be heard.
9	Relaxation	Government may relax; prior DoPT approval needed.
10	Interpretation	Referred to Government; decision final.



17. Self-Test — Quick Revision Q&A

Cover the answers and attempt first.

Q1. Under which constitutional provisions were the CCS (RSA) Rules, 1993 made?

Ans. The proviso to Article 309 and clause (5) of Article 148 of the Constitution.

Q2. What is the minimum membership a service association must have for recognition?

Ans. 35% of the total number of a category of employees.

Q3. When can a second association be recognised with less than 35%?

Ans. Only when one association already commands more than 35%; the second-highest may then be recognised if it has at least 15%.

Q4. By which date must the annual return reach the Government?

Ans. Before the 1st day of July each year, routed through proper channel after the AGM.

Q5. In which month may a member change the association he subscribes to, and when does it take effect?

Ans. The revised option may be exercised only in April, taking effect from July.

Q6. How is membership verified for recognition?

Ans. Through the check-off system (deduction of subscription from the pay-roll).

Q7. Which two groups of employees are outside these Rules?

Ans. Industrial employees of the Ministry of Railways, and workers in Defence Installations of the Ministry of Defence.

Q8. For breach of which rules can recognition be withdrawn, and subject to what?

Ans. Breach of Rule 5, 6 or 7 — after giving the association an opportunity to present its case.

Q9. Whose prior approval is needed before relaxing any requirement under Rule 9?

Ans. The Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT).

Q10. Can an association maintain a political fund?

Ans. No — Rule 6(c) prohibits maintaining any political fund or propagating any political party's views.



18. Sources & Verification Log

All provisions in this booklet were checked against the following sources on **29 June 2026**. Candidates are encouraged to consult the primary documents directly.

#	Source	Used for
1	DoPT — official text of the CCS (RSA) Rules, 1993 (Annexure-I), dopt.gov.in	Full text of Rules 1–10; signatory; preamble.
2	DoPT O.M. No. 2/10/80-JCA dated 9 November 1993 (forwarding O.M.)	Notification facts; GSR 689(E); supersession; relaxation & interpretation directions.
3	DoPT O.M. No. 2/10/80-JCA dated 31 January 1994	Check-off system; April option / July recovery; one-association rule.
4	Controller General of Accounts O.M. No. 9(4)/93/TA/Vol.II/4 dated 9 January 2001	Accounting & consolidation of subscriptions.
5	DoPT O.M.s of 2007 (Secretariat verification), 27 Sep 2023, 16 Aug 2024	Verification cycles; crucial-month concept; validity extensions.
6	DoPT F.No. 17/01/2025-R&R and DC series (Jul–Sep 2025) & Nov 2025 order	Current recognition/verification position; JCM Departmental Council linkage.

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Verified as on 29 June 2026. In case of conflict, the official Gazette / Government order prevails.